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Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Thursday, March 5, 2026

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[00:29:55] Senate chamber. The Senate will come to order. The senators will please take their

[00:31:03] seats. Those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery. The senators and all in attendance will please stand if you are able. We will be led in prayer today by Pastor Vernon Gordon from Life Church in Richmond and following the prayer everyone will please remain standing. We will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the flag of the United States of America by Senate page Evan Feld of Virginia Beach.

[00:31:33] May we bow. Almighty God, it is with both gratitude and and hope that we stand here today with thanksgiving for life, for breath, and for strength.

[00:31:49] We thank you for the gift of responsibility and influence. May we steward it with our words and our witness. We know inherently that it is talent that brought many of us to this room, but it is teamwork that will help us thrive beyond it.

[00:32:05] So it is in these moments that we invite your presence and your perspective, your strength and your strategy. And as generations peek back at the building blocks we lay today, may they say that our sound carried peace, that our steps carried power, that our solutions carried love, that our strategies carried strength, and that our stories carried hope. Give us the fortitude to stay the course in leading. Give us the wisdom to build bridges instead of walls. Give us the patience to ensure that seasons beyond us will benefit from the work that we have done today.

[00:32:36] and may we be reminded that our faith without our works is dead so help us align our acts with our thoughts our hands with our hearts and our feet with our faith and may we carry in spirit the african proverb of old that if we want to go fast we go alone but if we want to go far we go together go before us go with us and be within us as we lead today it's in your name we pray amen

[00:33:05] I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America and to the republic for one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:33:27] Clerk will call the roll. All those present, please vote aye. Clerk will close the roll.

[00:34:14] You have a quorum, Madam President. Senate Journal for Wednesday, March 4, 2026. The Senator from Eastern Henrico moves that the reading of the journal be waived. All in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their votes aye.

[00:34:32] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? All senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 34, noes 5. Ayes 34, noes 5.

[00:34:48] The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the House of Delegates. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Good afternoon, Madam President. Good afternoon. Madam President, I move to waive the reading of the communications from the House of Delegates.

[00:35:07] The question is, shall the reading of the communication be waived? All in favor of waiving the reading of the communication from the House of Delegates will record their votes. Aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[00:35:25] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 33, noes 6. Ayes 33, noes 6. The reading of the communication is waived. The clerk will report any communications from the governor.

[00:35:41] We do not have any, Madam President. We've now arrived at the time in our morning hour when we have the pleasure of welcoming our distinguished guests who are joining us today in the Senate gallery. I give my daily reminder about our procedure.

[00:35:58] A senator will rise and provide the introduction for his or her guest. I will then provide the welcome of the Senate. I ask that we all hold our applause until I've had the opportunity to share the Senate's welcome. The chair recognizes the senator from Richmond.

[00:36:16] Madam President, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Yes, Madam President, it is my pleasure to introduce the pastor who led us in our invocation this morning. It was led and given by Pastor Vernon Gordon, I would ask that he would stand.

[00:36:33] He's a passionate leader of leaders, a visionary, and a bridge builder. Vernon lives out his calling as a communicator of hope, helping people pursue their future free from fear. That purpose is shaped in part by his personal journey as a cancer survivor, an experience that reinforces belief that time is precious and purpose should never be delayed.

[00:36:57] He serves as lead and founding pastor of the Life Church TLC with locations in Richmond and Alexandria and is recognized as a motivational and monumental leader dedicated to the cultural influence and changing lives each and every day. He's the founder of the Mosaic Project, a nonprofit focused on inspiring social change and cultural unity, and co-founder of Gordon Solutions, a leadership consulting firm alongside of his wife, who was a member of the Village of Faith, where I pastored when they first started dating. Vernon attended Virginia Commonwealth University and

[00:37:34] earned his Master of Divinity from the Samuel DeWitt Proctor School of Theology at Virginia Union University. He is married to his high school sweetheart Ashley and together they are raising their two children Madison and Jackson. He not only has one of the fastest growing churches in the Commonwealth but actually has one of the fastest growing churches in the country. He is doing an outstanding job and i'm glad that he is here with us today madam president and i would wish that we would extend a very warm senate welcome to my good friend pastor vernon gordon i thank the senator for

[00:38:10] that introduction and welcome to pastor gordon thank you so much for the passionate prayer that you offered this morning and uh just from the the words that you shared with us it's easy to see how you are having such an impact throughout not just the spiritual community that you serve but so many of the different communities that you serve and represent in Richmond area. We are deeply grateful for your work. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to Pastor Vernon

[00:38:40] Gordon of the Life Church in Richmond. The Senator from, the Senior Senator from Prince William.

[00:38:56] Thank you Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank - Thank you, Madam President. Today we have in the gallery, George Mason students as well as his president. And so on behalf of other alumni here in the Senate, on behalf of the Senator from Western Fairfax, Senator Bukarski, Central Fairfax, Senator Saleem, Colonial Heights, Senator Sturdivant, and Senator from Orange, Senator Reeves.

[00:39:21] Madam President, I'd like you to give the warm welcome to President of George Mason, Dr. Gregory Washington, and members of Mason's Student Government Association, representing the over 100 Mason students who travel to Richmond today for Mason lobbies. And in 2025, Mason celebrates its largest graduating class with over 10,000 degrees conferred.

[00:39:42] With just over 40,000 students, Mason is proud to be the largest and most diverse public university in Virginia. And Mason strives for inclusion and accessibility. Those efforts were recently recognized by US News and Wall Street Journal and Washington Monthly, all citing Mason as number one in social mobility among Virginia public universities.

[00:40:02] As a Mason alum, I'm honored to introduce President Washington and these outstanding students for advocating and joining us in the gallery. And Madam President, please provide them the warm welcome of the Senate. - Thank you, Senator, for that introduction and welcome to George Mason University, to the students who are part of the student leadership program for the work that you are doing and certainly a very warm welcome to President Gregory Washington.

[00:40:26] We're just delighted that you are here today. And from the Senator's introduction, it seems that you have a monopoly on alumni in the Senate chamber. So very proud of all that you do to serve so many throughout the Commonwealth and the tremendous leadership that our students are providing.

[00:40:44] And I'm delighted that they've been able to join us and certainly hope you've had wonderful conversations with your legislators all throughout today. senators i ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to the president of george mason university president gregory washington and the students who are part of the leadership team that

[00:41:03] are here this afternoon madam president a message from the house please receive it the delegate from

[00:41:42] manassas delegate maldonado thank you good morning madam president i've been directed by the speaker of the house of delegates to inform the senate that pursuant to rule 13 of hjr 29 the house of delegates has suspended the special and continuing joint order relating to judicial elections until Tuesday March 10th 2026 at the conclusion of the morning hour and requests the concurrence of the Senate. Thank you. Thank you

[00:42:10] delegate. The chair recognizes the senator from King George. Thank you madam president good morning. Good morning. I rise for the purposes of two introductions. Senator has the floor. Thank you madam president. Madam president members in the gallery today we have the Dean of the University of Richmond School of Law where I went to school and I try not to embarrass them.

[00:42:45] Madam President, we have a commending resolution that will pass later today, commending Dean Wendy Perdue. And for more than 15 years, she's led the school with vision and integrity, building a premier writing program, expanding practical learning opportunities for students and strengthening faculty while overseeing a 27 and a half million dollar renovation of the law school.

[00:43:12] She served as the president of the Association of American Law Schools. The vice president of Order of the Coif was inducted into the Virginia Lawyers Hall of Fame and was named as a Virginia Lawyers Weekly 2025 Circle of Excellence Honoree. And at the conclusion of this academic year, Dean Perdue is going to step down.

[00:43:34] But under her leadership, the University of Richmond School of Law has continued a deep tradition of preparing graduates who go on to be lawyers, judges, policy makers, very, very integral in their community and specifically and most importantly in Virginia.

[00:43:55] And I think that's a wonderful thing when we educate these folks that they stay here in Virginia. So Madam President, on behalf of the senators from Henrico and me, I would ask that you offer Dean Perdue a warm welcome of the Senate.

[00:44:13] Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and welcome to Dean Wendy Perdue for joining us today in the Senate gallery. And thank you especially for the dedicated service to the School of Law at the University of Richmond. I've had the benefit myself of having externs join my office over the past few years and the students have always been exceptional.

[00:44:37] We're deeply grateful for your commitment and service to preparing our future attorneys and the leadership that you have provided to the School of Law, not just here in the Richmond area, but it sounds like on a national level as well.

[00:44:52] So thank you so much, wishing you a very, very happy retirement. I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to Dean Wendy Perdue, Senator from King George.

[00:45:12] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, also in the gallery today are friends and family of Marty Farber. Now, if you've been here for a while, you know who Marty Farber was. If you have not been here for a while, you did.

[00:45:30] We have a memorial resolution that's going to pass later today honoring Marty Farber. He joined the Division of Legislative Services in 1984, and he served the General Assembly until his well-earned retirement in 2016.

[00:45:49] He primarily supported the House Conservation and Natural Resources Committee, the House Committee on Chesapeake and its tributaries, and the Senate Committee on Agriculture, Conservation and Natural Resources. And during his tenure at the Division of Legislative Services, he saw the recodification of Title 3.1, and he conducted studies a lot on combined sewer outflows, slant drilling under the Chesapeake Bay, water withdrawal surcharges, and other topics that affect the health and stability of the Commonwealth's waterways and natural resources.

[00:46:23] After his brother's death in 2015, he guided his nieces and their children through a very difficult period of time for them in their lives. And today we have in the gallery one of his nieces, Ellie, his other two nieces, I believe, Madam President, are watching us online.

[00:46:43] Many of Marty's family and friends came today to honor him, including former Speaker of the House, Kirk Cox, whom I just saw up there, and folks from across the political spectrum, and that defines Marty. So, I was a young legislator, Republican, and I came to the General Assembly, and Marty and I shared a passion for natural resources.

[00:47:07] And I would venture to say that we became friends. He tutored me, he helped me. If you wanted to work on natural resources, and you can tell, some of the areas that he focused on are areas that I care a great deal about.

[00:47:22] He taught me the ins and outs, and he helped me tremendously. And while I'm probably not a very good legislator, Marty made me the best legislator I could be, and for that I will be eternally grateful. We miss him a great deal, and I just learned of his passing last fall, and I thought that it would be appropriate for us to honor Marty, who was such an integral part of our General Assembly family and so Madam President I would ask that you please offer Marty's

[00:47:59] friends and family a warm welcome of the Senate. Thank You Senator for that introduction and I joined the senator in in the expressions of gratitude that we all feel for the service that Marty provided to so many of us in his efforts in our in the Division of Legislative Services but most especially around the issues of natural resources conservation those of us who served on the agriculture conservation natural resources committee certainly know the fine expertise that he had all of the research that he did on behalf of so much

[00:48:37] of the legislation that we have been working on we are so indebted to his commitment his service to the Commonwealth we offer our condolences to to the friends and the family of Marty Faber and we are honored to be able to recognize his lifetime of service and commitment to the Commonwealth. Senators I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the friends and family

[00:49:03] who have gathered here in recognition of the service of Marty Faber. Chair recognizes the senator from Orange. Thank you Madam President. Arise for an introduction. The senator has the floor. Madam President, in the gallery today we

[00:49:37] have Julia Dupre-Gion, and Julia has been interning in my office this session and has just done an amazing job. She's a high school student from Roanoke, so on behalf of the senator from Roanoke, you missed this one and I got her so you can't keep her. She serves with a lot of passion. She's currently taking a class in constitutional law and in the past she has volunteered on some political campaigns and participated in mock government debates. Julia has also been part of the robotics team for five years. She enjoys reading music and value

[00:50:16] member our team. Again, Madam President, it's been honored to have her alongside this year. She is sometimes shy until you really get to know her, but I ask that you give her the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction and welcome to Julia, and I hope I pronounced your name correctly, Julia Dupre-Guillaume. Thank you so much for the work that you have done in the senator's office this session. I'm sure that you not only learned a lot but that you contributed so much given the areas of expertise that you have been able to bring to the senator's office. We're delighted to have you in the gallery

[00:50:52] today. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to Julia Dupre-Guillaume. The chair recognizes a senator from Central Fairfax. Thank you madam president. I rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank you madam president. Today in the gallery we have the members of the Democratic Latino Organization of Virginia or known as DLOVE which is a statewide branch of the Democratic Party of Virginia dedicated to activating and

[00:51:31] empowering Latino civic and political engagement across the Commonwealth. Today we're showcasing the strength, diversity, and the leadership of Virginia's Latino community, leaders shaping policy, advocacy, and public service at every level. D-LOVE proudly led the Latinos for Spamberger effort, helping drive Latino engagement that contributed to a decisive two-to-one margin of victory.

[00:51:57] So with that, Madam President, I hope that you would give them the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and welcome to the Democratic Latinos of Virginia, otherwise known as DLOVE. We are so delighted to have you join us in the gallery today, but especially thankful for all of the work that you do to advocate and represent communities all across Virginia on critical issues such as education, healthcare, and so many concerns that impact communities everywhere in Virginia.

[00:52:31] you for joining us. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to the representatives of D. Love. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach. There he is. He's ready. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an announcement. Senator has the floor. We're sorry, I rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I rise today and it's my

[00:53:08] distinct honor to introduce the founders and leadership of the Officer Down Memorial Page, an organization we recently commended through Senate Resolution 47 for three decades of service to the law enforcement community. In 1996, while still a freshman at James Madison University, Chris Cogsgriff founded the Officer Down Memorial Page after learning that the individual responsible for murdering two police officers had been released from prison after serving just 16 years. Determined that fallen officers would never be forgotten Chris built what has become the most comprehensive law enforcement

[00:53:45] memorial organization in the United States for 28 years he served as the face of ODMP giving countless media interviews and earning national recognition fulfilling a lifelong dream Chris became a Fairfax County police officer in 2013 rising to his current rank of captain and now serves as board Chair and Executive Director Emeritus. Alongside him from the beginning at JMU has been Mike Schultz, ODMP's Treasurer and Technical Director. Mike helped build the technological foundation that

[00:54:19] allows millions of people a year to access the stories and data that honor more than 27,000 fallen officers. Leading the organization today is Executive Director Sandra Hunnisett, who has served ODMP for 15 years from incident research to managing the day-to-day operations. Sandra has strengthened and expanded the organization's impact. Also present in the gallery is digital director John Shemute and his family. Through their dedication the ODMP ensures that the

[00:54:56] sacrifice of our fallen heroes is never lost in history. I'm proud to welcome and recognize these extraordinary individuals and ask you please welcome and give them the warmest welcome in the Senate thank you thank you senator for that introduction and welcome to the representatives of the officer down memorial page organization the service that you provide is absolutely essential so that we may honor and remember and keep in our hearts those officers who have served so valiantly for all of our communities and thank you for helping

[00:55:34] us to continue that recognition so that their names and their lives are never forgotten. Senators I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to our representatives from the Officer Downe Memorial Page organization. The senator from Richmond City. Thank You Madam President I rise for the purpose of another introduction. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Today we are joined by

[00:56:10] members of We Off the Couch, a Richmond-based, black-led nonprofit dedicated to advancing health equity through running and fitness. If they're in the gallery, I'd ask them to stand. Founded in 2019 by Anthony after his own transformative health journey, the organization was created to share the power of movement, wellness, and community. What began with just two runners has grown into a movement of more than 1,200 members who came together throughout the week.

[00:56:41] Their motto, Your Pace, Your Race, reflects their commitment to inclusion and the belief that no one is ever left behind. To date, the organization has supported more than 500 individuals in training for races across the region and has received support from the Richmond Health Equity Fund and the Robbins Foundation.

[00:57:02] We have a commending resolution in which we will act upon today, but Madam President, We Off the Couch demonstrates that wellness extends far beyond physical health. It is about mental health, emotional support, and building lasting community. We're proud to recognize them today, and I would ask that we would extend a warm Senate welcome.

[00:57:21] Thank you, Madam President. Thank you, Senator, for the introduction, and welcome to the representatives of We Off the Couch. just hearing the senator describe the critical work that the organization does is so amazing we know that mental health and the improvements of our lives are so dependent on the activities that each of us engage in physically and the impact that you are having across so many communities and delivering that message but also putting it into action is very very commendable so we thank you for all

[00:57:56] the work that you are doing and certainly hope uh that we all get off the couch soon so thank you thank you for joining us today senators i ask that we give the very warm welcome of the senate to our representatives from the we off the couch organization the senator from arlington thank you madam president madam president i rise to note in absence senator has the floor thank you

[00:58:31] madam president the senior senator from fairfax is out on pressing personal business i would like the journal to reflect that the journal will so reflect thank you senator the senate senior senator from henrico thank you madam president madam president i rise for an introduction senator has the floor thank you madam president and uh members of the senate joining us in the gallery are students from uh fourth grade students from they know St. Michael's Episcopal School. Don't say "all" yet. These students have

[00:59:10] been practicing all year with Richmond Ballet Minds in Motion program, which helps students gain a greater understanding of themselves through dance. They will join other fourth grade classes from schools throughout Richmond and Chesterfield for their culminating performance in April. I had the pleasure of spending some time with them today I think they enjoyed it I enjoyed it Edwin when who is the page is not page I like that when I think everybody likes Wayne

[00:59:49] is in the eighth grade at st. Michael and these are fourth graders Edwin's class came I didn't think it could get more adorable than Edwards class but these young people have them beat I spent more time than I should have this morning with them every one of them had about three or four questions and then I took

[01:00:19] them to my office about six or seven at a time and we just enjoyed each other's company and I just think the world of these young people and madam president Richmonders and so I think once you all

leave town I'll start having lunch with them because it's just been cool and it really blessed my heart because I got a note that said you know sometimes they split the group up and half of them go

[01:00:56] to the house and half of them go to this come to the Senate all of them wanted to come to the Senate so madam president they're already making good decisions in life and I'm just thrilled that they were they spent some time with me and they felt my office I didn't tell him what floor was on I said it was either on the sixth floor or the seventh floor but madam president I hope that you would give them the warm welcome of the Senate thank you senator for that

[01:01:33] introduction I have I have a feeling I know why they all came to the Senate gallery. I have to agree with you, Senator, that we have a high quota of adorability in the Senate gallery this morning, so we are so excited to have the lovely fourth grade class, the fourth grade students from St. Michael's Episcopal Church, and as you shared, Senator, the one way to continue the work

[01:02:12] that these fourth graders have already started in talking to you is to join us as pages in a few years so we certainly hope to see some of you back as Senate pages or perhaps even House pages in the next few years we would love to have you back and thank you senator for providing them with such a warm welcome in your office which may or may not be on the sixth floor or the seventh floor we're not quite sure, but thank you. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome

[01:02:44] of the Senate to St. Michael's Episcopal School's fourth grade class. Senator from Western Fairfax, I'm not sure if you're going to be able to beat that introduction. I know, jeez, Madam President, I'm gonna I'm gonna try to go after that, but in, I do rise for an introduction. Senator has the floor. In In the gallery today, we have my intern, Sophia Tia,

[01:03:24] who I thank you for standing up. Sophie's a freshman at the University of Richmond and is double majoring in political science and leadership studies. She's also a 2023 graduate of the FBI National Academy's 24th Youth Leadership Program.

[01:03:45] Sophie joined my office this session to observe and to learn more about how Virginia state government operates, to gain some experience with the process, and to further explore her own passion and interest in public policy.

[01:04:02] Sophie has lofty dreams and big plans for what's next for her. So after her graduation in 2029 from the university, she plans to attend law school with a goal of serving public as a prosecutor and potentially pursuing a career with the FBI later on.

[01:04:24] I'm grateful for the work that Sophie has done for us during the session, for her contributions. Her intellect, her work ethic, and her passion to help us has been very appreciated and we've We've had a great opportunity to get to know her a little better.

[01:04:45] And another little special fact about Sophie is that she happens to be the daughter of a highly regarded and well-respected pediatrician in our community, Ghassanatia, who for the last 23 years and through six children has had to deal with me.

[01:05:06] And I have been very appreciative for his help in helping me keep my children healthy and where they are today. And I hope that I have done a little bit of the same favor with working with Sophie and welcoming her here and just championing her further pursuits and being here to help her.

[01:05:31] So I hope you join me in the welcome. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction, and welcome to Sophie Atiyah. Thank you so much for being not just here in the Senate gallery, but especially for the work you've done throughout this session in the Senator's office.

[01:05:47] I certainly hope you've learned a lot. We're proud of all that you've already accomplished, and we look forward to your continued success, particularly as you pursue a career in law. Senators, I ask that we give the very warm welcome of the Senate to Sophie Atiyah from the Senator from Western Fairfax's office. Is there any other business for the morning hour?

[01:06:22] The clerk will call the Callan. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. Pursuant to Rule 13 of H.J.R. 29, which is our scheduling resolution, I move the special and continuing joint order relating to judicial elections be suspended until Tuesday, March the 10th, 2026. And speak to that motion. Senator has the floor. Hey, Madam President. Ladies and to send we're going to move the judicial election date to tuesday march the 10th there's one more circuit that hasn't figured out uh who they want in two spots um that's going to be the last

[01:06:58] continuance granted uh and i hope we can adopt that so we can get judges over tuesday march 10. the question is pursuant to rule 13 of hjr 29 the scheduling resolution shall the special and continuing joint order relating to judicial elections be suspended until tuesday march 10th 2026. all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to

[01:07:34] change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 39 no zero ayes 39 no zero the special and continuing joint order is suspended until tuesday march 10th 2026. the clerk will call the calendar

[01:08:03] senate calendar for thursday march the 5th 2006 turning to page six conference committee report on senate bill 27. the senator from eastern prince william thank you madam president madam president i ask that we adopt the conference committee report will the senator speak to that motion oh yes

[01:08:39] and speaking to that we have come to terms with the house on agreed language the house did have some recommendations and amendments that we wanted to adopt here just clarifying some definitions and some technical clarifications here and so we do have an agreement we ask that you adopt the conference committee report the senior senator from Virginia Beach thank you madam president will the patron yield for a quick question I

[01:09:14] yield will the senator yield I yield senator from Virginia Beach thank you I just asked a quick question are state employees exempt or included in this now senator for the firearm gun industry bill whoops I'm sorry madam president Wrong bill.

[01:09:41] I apologize. No worries. The question is, shall the Senate adopt the conference committee report for Senate Bill 27? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[01:09:58] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19.

[01:10:14] The Senate adopts the conference committee report. Turning to page 15, Unfinished Business House, House Bill 118.

[01:10:31] The House has rejected the Senate substitute. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that we insist and request the committee of conference. The question is, shall the Senate insist and

request a committee of conference for House Bill 118?

[01:10:51] All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed know, are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll.

[01:11:09] Ayes 39, no, 0. Ayes 39, no, 0. The Senate insists and requests a committee of conference. Ayes bill 1208. The House has rejected the Senate substitute.

[01:11:25] Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I insist on our Senate substitute and request a committee of conference. The question is, shall the Senate insist and request a Committee of Conference for House Bill 1208? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[01:11:44] Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 38, noes 0.

[01:12:03] Ayes 38, noes 0. The Senate insists on a Committee of Conference. Unfinished Business Senate. - Senate Bill 73 has passed the House with Amendment.

[01:12:22] - Senator, the junior senator from Loudoun. - Thank you, Madam President. I move the Senate concur with the House Amendment and speaking to that motion. - Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. As a reminder, this bill seeks to provide additional support and resources for local school divisions to take advantage of school-based Medicaid services.

[01:12:42] The House Amendment simply seeks to clarify that while DMAS may provide training and guidance, should not be responsible for directing for directly submitting claims for the school divisions to the same as the same agency is responsible for reviewing and overseeing those claims i re-create my motion that the house amendments be agreed to thank you the question is shall the senate concur with the house amendment for senate bill 73 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[01:13:19] senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0.

[01:13:34] The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 100 has passed the House with amendment. The Senator from Franklin County. Thank you Madam President. I now move that we concur with the House Amendment to SB 100 and speaking to that. Senator has the floor. Thank you. Members of the Senate, basically if you'll remember this was a bill that protected our voluntary and emergency responders when they would have to leave their job to respond to an emergency that they could not be fired for that there was some language that in the

[01:14:12] house side we just cleaned up when it came to allowing that person who must respond to a fire in lieu of taking unpaid time off for such service the employee may use paid sick leave or other paid leave if the employee has accrued or is entitled to such leave thereby allowing them to be paid during that time off so based on that man president I now move once again that we concur with the house amendment the question is shall the Senate concur with the house amendment to Senate bill 100 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the

[01:14:50] senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 175 is passed the House with amendment. Senator from Western Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move we concur with the House

amendment in speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, this is the bill that increases the carve-out for the solar projects and as well as the carve-out for previously developed sites like landfills,

[01:15:27] brownfields parking lots except industrial sites what the amendment does is strike the section about undergrounding which was also done on the house version and so I would move that we concur with the house amendment the question is shall the Senate concur with the house amendment to Senate bill 175 all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no are the senators ready to vote. Have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to

[01:16:01] change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, noes 16. Ayes 23, noes 16. The Senate concurs. Senate bill 183 has passed the House with amendment. Senator from Norfolk. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I move that the Senate concur with the House amendment and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor thank you madam president the house amendment for SB 183 makes a small

[01:16:39] but important clarification by removing the word standardized from the identification requirement this change ensures that restaurants are not required to adopt a single uniform labeling system instead it allows restaurants the flexibility to identify modified items in the manner that best fits their existing operations. Madam President, with that I respectfully ask for concurrence in the House Amendment. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House Amendment for Senate Bill 183? All in favor of that motion will record

[01:17:16] their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 21, noes 18. Ayes 21, noes 18. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill Article 199 has passed the House with a substitute.

[01:17:42] Senator from Arlington. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, with the recommendation that the substitute be rejected, I move that we concur with the substitute. Speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. The House substitute is significantly different from what the Senate passed.

[01:18:02] As you might recall, members, I had a tiered process and several delayed dates for the small businesses to come under the requirement for paid sick days. I also had language requiring the Department of Labor to issue regulations.

[01:18:22] Both of those provisions are absent from the House bill, and the House bill added considerably provisions that will impact the fiscal analysis of this bill. So again, I just renew my motion. The recommendation that it be rejected, that's red, I move that the substitute be agreed to. Thank you. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 199? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye.

[01:18:54] those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll zero knows 39 I zero knows 39 the Senate does not concur Senate bill 253 has passed the house with the substitute senator from Portsmouth thank you madam president madam president with the recommendation that the house substitute

[01:19:31] be rejected a move that the substitute be agreed to and speaking to that motion senator has the floor madam president the house substitute is missing a key provision related to allocation of cost onto

data centers that was in the bill when it passed this body unanimously we need to get the bill into conference to ensure it addresses affordability of electric services in the manner we originally intended with that i will renew my motion with the recommendation the house substitute be rejected with the recommendation that it be rejected the question is shall the senate concur

[01:20:08] with the house substitute for senate bill 253 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i see a zero nose 39 i zero No.

[01:20:34] 39. The Senate does not concur. Senate Bill 278 has passed a House with amendments. Junior Senator from Loudoun. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:20:50] I move that the Senate concur with the House amendments. I'm speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. As a reminder, Senate Bill 278 is my bill directing the Secretary of Health and Human Resources to convene a stakeholder work group to evaluate the impact of the federal 340 drug pricing program in Virginia and provide the General Assembly with a data driven assessment and recommendations to inform potential state legislative action including transparency and contract pharmacy access the line amendments added in the house are technical in nature to correct the name

[01:21:27] of the federal statute and also to clarify that one of the goals of the study these are not substantive changes I renew my motion that the Senate concur with the House amendments. Thank you. The question is, shall the Senate concur with the House amendments for Senate Bill 278? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no, zero. Ayes 39, no, zero. The Senate

[01:22:06] concurs senate bill 361 has passed the house with a substitute senator from eastern prince william yes madam president uh madam president asked that we concur with the house substitute and speaking to the motion um yes senator has the floor speaking to that motion um we actually do agree with the house um changes they're technical in nature and um we would ask

[01:22:42] that the uh we concur to the house substitute we do things such as define contraception as an action taken to prevent pregnancy we actually refer to products legally marketed under federal food drug and cosmetic act and we remove redundant language as unnecessary that was placed in the senate bill but it's not in the house and so after speaking with stakeholders this is a great compromise and we ask that we concur with the House substitute. The question is,

[01:23:21] shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate bill 361? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 23, no 16. Ayes 23, no 16.

[01:23:46] the senate concurs senate bill 396 has passed the house with a substitute senator from york thank you madam president i move that the senate concur with the house substitute and speak into that motion senator has the floor the house substitute does not change the essence of the bill but makes technical changes as requested by the dmv and has an enactment date of january 1st

[01:24:17] 2027 the question is shall the senate concur with the house substitute for senate bill 396 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 25 nose 14. ayes 25 nose 14. the senate concurs

[01:24:54] Senate Bill 644 has passed the House with a substitute. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. With the recommendation that we reject the House substitute, a move that we concur. Speaking of that. Senator has the floor.

[01:25:10] Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, the Senate, this is the bill that overhauls a lot of our employment rules regarding overtime, prevailing wage, minimum wage, and employees' ability to misclassification, employees' ability to bring suit over that, etc.

[01:25:26] The House made a few changes to this, which we're not good with. Also, my bill's, or the other bill's going to conference, so we just need to reject this so the whole thing can go to conference and get it worked out and figure it out. Hope we can reject. With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 644?

[01:25:48] All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll i zero knows 39 i zero no 39 the senate does not concur senate bill 693 has passed the house with amendments senator from isle of white thank you madam president i'd like to uh move that we accept the house amendments and concur with those and speaking to that senator has the floor thank you

[01:26:26] madam president um we just worked with uh stakeholders to change a couple minor words including policyholder and appropriate language and work with SEC to make sure that the intent of the bill was not changed and with that would move we concur with the House amendments. The question is shall the Senate concur with the House amendments for Senate Bill 693? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will

[01:27:04] close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate concurs. Senate Bill 790 has passed the House with a substitute. Senator from Hanover. Thank you Madam President. Madam President, I move the Senate concur with the House amendments and speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor.

[01:27:28] Madam President, the House amendments were two things. One, it was a technical drafting error that we caught along the way to make this include application to HMOs and then the second was an enactment clause that allows Virginia to be protected in case the new federal rule that would apply to CMS goes into effect. The question is shall the Senate concur with the House substitute for Senate Bill 790? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no.

[01:28:04] are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The Senate concurs.

[01:28:21] Senate Bill 803 has passed the House with a substitute. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that we concur with the House substitute and I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, ladies and gentlemen, Senate, you may remember that this This legislation was aimed at preventing quid pro quo harassment in housing.

[01:28:43] At the other end of the hall, we worked with the Attorney General's Office through a couple of different substitutes to try to present something, a bill that actually did something and did not conflict with federal law. And at the end of the day, this substitute comes from the Attorney General's Office and just directs the Fair Housing Board to promulgate regulations that are essentially consistent with federal law.

[01:29:04] I'd ask you to pass the bill pass the substitute the question is shall the Senate concur with the house substitute for Senate bill 803 all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote Have all the Senate senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll I was 23 no 16 eyes 23 no 16 the Senate concurs Senate bill 692 the house has

[01:29:42] The House insists on its substitute and request a Committee of Conference. Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. I move that we accede to the request for Committee of Conference so they can hear why their former member, our Chair of Public Education, amended the bill in such a good way.

[01:30:02] Thank you, Madam President. The question is, shall the Senate accede to a Committee of Conference for Senate Bill 692? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. The Senate accedes to a committee of conference. Comfries on the part of the Senate is named by the chair of Education and Health, Senator

[01:30:37] Pavola, or Senator Suterland, Ayrd, and Perry. On House Bill 77, Comfries on the part of the Senate is named by the Chair of Transportation Senator Bagby, Senators

[01:31:03] Serville, Bennett Parker, and Diggs. Turning to page 30, Senate Bills with Governor's Recommendations. Senate Bill 51. The junior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President Ross. Make a motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I move to amend the bill in accordance with the recommendation of the governor. Speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor.

[01:31:43] thank you madam president um following the virginia beach's 10-1 referendum election the state court ruled to set aside the city's election system the court came to this decision in order number one to see how the referendum would turn out and number two how the general assembly would respond to the referendum result currently we have candidates filing to run an upcoming city council and school board elections however the registrar is holding the paperwork waiting for this to be resolved, which has led to a delay in election administration.

[01:32:17] Incomments, candidates, and citizens of Virginia each need this to be resolved as soon as possible, and we cannot wait until the regular enactment date of July 1. Adoptment of this emergency clause will give finality and direction for this year's election process, which is already in motion. With that, I move the bill to pass, the amendment to pass.

[01:32:35] The question is, the question is, shall the bill be amended in accordance with the recommendation of the governor all in favor of amending the bill in accordance with the recommendation of the governor will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 20 noes 19 ayes 20 noes 19 the Senate has agreed to amend the bill in

[01:33:09] accordance with the recommendation of the governor Senate bill 681 the junior senator from virginia beach thank you madam president i move to amend the bill in accordance with the recommendation of the governor speaking to that motion senator has the floor thank you madam president for um for the explanation i just gave for uh senate bill 51 um this applies as well but it's dealing with our charter um they're still with the virginia beach charter and this legislation this amendment cannot wait until july 1 because we already have an upcoming election

[01:33:47] process as well as making sure that the city can get on withholding its election administration and with that i move passage or acceptance of the governor's recommendation the question is shall the bill be amended in accordance with the recommendation of the governor all in favor of amending the bill in accordance with the recommendation of the governor will record their votes i those opposed know are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[01:34:18] Senators desire to change their vote. The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 22, no 17. Ayes 22, no 17. The Senate has agreed to amend the bill in accordance with the recommendation of the Governor.

[01:34:35] Uncontested calendar. House bills on third reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move that all the House bills on third reading on the uncontested calendars on pages 31 through 34, House Bill 323 to 1360 be advanced their final passage in a block of the adoption of any amendments thereto.

[01:34:55] That any senator desiring to move a bill from the block shall do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall the House bills on the uncontested calendar, third reading, pages 31 through 34, House Bill 323 through House Bill 1360, be placed upon their final passage in the block after the adoption of any amendments thereto, with the understanding that any senator desiring a bill be removed from the block, will do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill.

[01:35:26] all in favor of that motion we'll say aye those opposed no the ayes have it the motion is agreed to the bills are now before us in the block the clerk will read the number of the bills House bill 323 House bill 350 excuse me 323 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor House bill 358 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with an amendment Senator from Charlottesville Madam President I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. The question is shall the amendment from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be

[01:36:02] agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed no. The ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to. House Bill 479 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. House Bill 481 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President I the Committee of Substitute be agreed to. The question is, shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:36:36] The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. As bill 490, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. As bill 736, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. As bill 826, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. As bill 1022, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the Committee of Substitute be agreed to. The question is shall the substitute from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in

[01:37:12] favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The substitute is agreed to. House Bill 1151 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. House Bill 1218 reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. House House Bill 1307, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor.

[01:37:39] House Bill 1360, reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor. The question is, shall the House bills in the block pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no. Are the Senators ready to vote?

[01:37:54] Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no, zero. Ayes 39, no, zero. bills in the block pass regular calendar has bills on third reading has bill 55 a bill relating to noise abatement monitoring systems local authority civil penalties the committee amendment has been

[01:38:26] adopted by the senate the senior senator from henrico thank you madam president madam president can that bill go back for the day without objection house bill 55 goes by for the day House Bill 888, a bill relating to minimum all-street parking requirements in certain areas, reported from the Committee on Local Government with a substitute.

[01:38:57] The Senator from Eastern Henrico. Thank you, Madam President. We are still working on that floor amendment, so may this please go by for the day. Without objection, House Bill 888 goes by for the day. House Bill 1207, a bill relating to paid family and medical leave insurance program notice requirements civil action reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with a substitute.

[01:39:28] Madam. From the Committee on Finance and Appropriations with a substitute. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, can that bill go by for the day? Without objection, House Bill 1207 goes by for the day. House Bill 242. A bill relating to public utilities multiple budget plan payment increases within 12 months prohibited. Notice required. Reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with an amendment.

[01:39:54] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendment from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to.

[01:40:10] senator from charlottesville madam president moving the bill passed i'd like to speak to that senator has the floor madam president this bill prohibits a public utility excluding water and sewer utilities from um from for any residential consumer who is enrolled in a budget plan to from increasing the amount of such customers monthly payment more than once within any 12 month period without notifying the customer in writing at least 60 days prior to such prior to the time such an increase again I hope you'll pass the

[01:40:46] bill the question is shall House bill 242 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 2. Ayes 37, noes 2. House bill 242 passes. House bill 395,

[01:41:22] a bill relating to electric utilities, small portable solar generation devices, residential landlord and tenant act. Reported from the committee on commerce and labor with a substitute and there is a floor

substitute. Senator from eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President, with the recommendation that it be rejected, I move the committee substitute.

[01:41:46] With the recommendation that it be rejected, the question is, shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The noes have it. The amendment is not agreed to.

[01:42:03] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Move the wave reading of the floor, sir. The question is, shall the reading of the floor substitute be waived? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed? No. The ayes have it. The reading is waived. Senator from Fairfax. Move the floor sub to speak of that motion.

[01:42:20] Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Ladies and gentlemen, Senate, this is the balcony solar bill that some people like to call it. Doing a floor sub to avoid a conference committee report, trying to keep this bill caught up with what happened in mind on the House side. So, and this is likely to be final passage, so I'm just going to walk you through the differences real quick.

[01:42:40] So as you all remember, this process would allow somebody to go out and buy one of these balcony solar, small portable solar systems hanging off the side of their balcony, hanging off the side of their trailer, hanging off the side of their house or whatever they want, plug it in, plug and play, and generate a little bit of power for themselves.

[01:42:59] They pay for themselves in two to five years. The edits that are in front of you reflect input from the investor-owned utilities, from co-ops and from the realtors who all had requested changes which were all incorporated in this first of all on page three the part about the locality language that's pretty much unchanged you go to page four under between line 98 102 makes clear that any of these devices have to have a thing on it that prevents it from back feeding what that means that the power goes out it won't stay on and generate power back into the system so if the powers out the old

[01:43:36] house you know won't electrocute somebody if they go to try to mess with things while power's out then on page five the changes you see on page five between lines 110 124 mainly things the realtors asked for asking that a tenant has to give notice to a landlord before they install one of these things and they have to give a certain amount of notice it also makes clear that if the tenant blows up the electrical system in an apart in a unit by putting one of these things in that they can't then sue the landlord for not having a operable electrical system then it also makes clear that if uh if an apartment building uses a ratio billing system

[01:44:12] um that uh they can't use it in that situation without the express written approval of the landlord because of its ratio billing it gets hard to figure out how to allocate the cost of electricity and then um on that beyond that um madam president you have to go to the end of the bill under on page 24, I think, sorry, 25 or no, 24. Again, you have the backfeeding stuff. You got a wattage limitation so that they can only be a bit of a certain size. Then, and then at the very

[01:44:45] end, there's a work group that was requested by the utilities to have our building code officials look at safety and see whether or not any building code changes are necessary to be able to accommodate these things going forward that's basically what the changes do i think this is a it's actually a really interesting concept uh utah is the only other state that's adopted this there's a million of these in use in germany and europe they're becoming very popular worldwide and this will put virginia at the forefront of

allowing people to generate their own power have some individual freedom and liberty and free themselves from the the grips of having to purchase power from

[01:45:25] the man yeah so madam president i hope we could pass the bill senator we must first move the amendment the question is shall the amendment be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the amendment are agreed to the chair recognizes the senator from king george thank you madam president would the gentleman yield for a question will the gentleman yield i'll yield and also move the bill pass if i have to do that too you have to do that

[01:46:00] after we've answered some questions senator all right thank you i'm not opposed to the to the bill but i had a thought about this bill um so it overrides localities and owners of buildings for instance i understand locality can't prevent you from putting on a single family residence or and i and i use that term which would include trailers and manufactured homes But if it's on an apartment building, this overrides any authority the landlord or the owner of the building may have.

[01:46:34] Have you addressed the insurability of these with regard to the overall building? In other words, do we know that insurance companies are going to insure these buildings and insure renters with these devices on the buildings?

[01:46:55] Senator from Fairfax. madam president what i would say is that uh you know this concept has been out there for discussion since probably september we studied this pretty thoroughly at the commission on electrical utility regulation for three months uh the insurance companies didn't come to us during that process to say that they saw a problem neither the landlords uh but then the bill has actually been filed you know since january the insurance companies haven't come on that the realtors did raise a whole series of issues which we've tried to accommodate and i would think if they had concerns about insuring their buildings we would have heard we would have heard from them there's an issue we haven't heard anything about that so that's the

[01:47:34] best way I can answer it. I thank the senator, Madam President. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. Will the gentleman from Orange rise for a quick question? Will the gentleman from Orange yield for a question? Madam President I rise. Senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you Madam President. Madam President I'd like to ask the gentleman from Orange, if this were insured, what would it take for a company to

[01:48:09] insure something like this? Where would the liability lie? And then would that individual be able to pay for an entire apartment complex if this were to lay on the renter's insurance? Senator from Orange.

[01:48:25] Madam President, there's several things to untangle in that question. A single family dwelling is insured differently than a multi-tenant apartment complex that's more of a commercial policy my greater concern I know it says in the bill on line or the substitute 115 the tenant shall be responsible for any damages sustained at a rental dwelling unit I guess I don't know how they would be held if my concern would be if that tenant didn't have renter's

[01:49:04] insurance for whatever reason to cover their items and let's say that thing burned their half the apartment complex down I don't know that an individual without renter's insurance is going to be able to cover any damages and I don't know how other than through subrogation the owner of the complex and the insurance company that has the let's say apartment complex covered would probably have to

subrogate against whoever the tenant had but I don't know how they'd ever recover those costs. Madam President, I thank the gentleman from Orange. And speaking to the

[01:49:41] bill, one appropriate. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I still have concern over this because these devices can, you can buy them off of Amazon for $1,000 to $1,500. If you're looking at one that's 391 watts, it's exempt from product listing provisions that we're require alternatives to the building premises wiring or electrical panels line 101 and 102 it basically says if you buy one of these and it's under 391

[01:50:19] watts and to put that into perspective that's a small microwave so that pulls quite a bit of power and my big concern on this is if you plug in one or two of these there's a potential at 1200 watts because that's what you're purchasing

[01:50:37] And that's what we're talking about here in line 93 and throughout the bill that you can quickly overwhelm the whether it's an apartment an older home a modular home a trailer you can quickly overwhelm the wiring in there and I know it doesn't say in here that it has to be professionally wired in for the backflow disconnect but that's still one of my concerns is folks are just going to go out they're going to buy one of these and say hey I can spend a thousand dollars I can cut my electric bill they're going to plug it into the wall and sure it might work but if it's an older house

[01:51:13] or if it's an older apartment building and it's wiring that might not be brand new wiring could have any kind of compromise in it then that would start a fire and not just that I just feel that this is not a smart thing to do I will compliment the senator from Fairfax with the way he at least is sending this to a work group and putting it into a reenactment clause because I think that's what's necessary on this but I think that this is one that I just can't support with those concerns

[01:51:53] and somebody's going to get hurt and then we're going to we're going to we're going to end up changing the law again and increasing insurance and we're going to complain that folks in apartments now are going to have super high insurance and it's just going to be a confounding factor that keeps building. But thank you very much. The chair recognizes the Senator from Orange.

[01:52:16] Thank you, Madam President. Speaking to the substitute. Senator has the floor. Madam President, looking at the substitute, 391 watts isn't a whole heck of a lot when you look at it overall. But what I would say, in addition to the senior senator from Virginia Beach's question and kind of his comments, is what we do on a typical dwelling unit, home unit, let's say you want to get solar panels put on your house and you want to have or even a backup generator those are typically installed by a professional a licensed electrician or a company that's gonna going to cover any kind of damages under

[01:52:56] the installation now you're having a private citizen just come in and plug this thing in with no guarantees. I would say typically we cover these kind of issues on an insurance policy with a separate writer to cover that if you were going to put it in your home. I don't know if there's even any product out there to cover this as a separate writer to a renter's policy or anything else but maybe to the patron of the bill that might be something as they study to look at some kind of rider that the insurance companies could put on it.

[01:53:33] The Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. I moved that the bill passed and speaking briefly to the motion. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Now that we're in the

posture that we can advance the bill, I think this is the way we ought to be doing solar all across the Commonwealth.

[01:53:54] I don't love seeing large amounts of farmland be switched to industrial solar. That is not something that makes me feel good happening in our commonwealth. I respect people who have property rights to do that, but you'll also note that I vote pretty tough on a lot of those issues.

[01:54:12] But this is how we ought to be doing it. This is balcony solar, letting folks do this, not having local governments restrict them. I appreciate all the stakeholders doing this, and I hope we'll advance the bill. The senator from Western Henrico. Madam President, speaking to the bill.

[01:54:28] Senator has the floor. Madam President, the senator from Roanoke stole most of my thunder. But I'm just going to say, I can't wait to buy one of these to lower the cost of my energy bill. This is an affordability bill. That's a great bill. Everybody should vote yes. Let's go.

[01:54:45] Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. If nobody else desires to speak, speaking to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. I appreciate all the now bipartisan enthusiasm for this concept. And I look forward to buying my own as well. I have too many trees to generate a lot of electricity in my house.

[01:55:02] But two things. First of all, with regard to the insurance issue, if landlords want to make sure their tenants have insurance in order to pay for things, then landlords just need to simply require that as part of their lease and make sure their tenants have renter's insurance. And most landlords that are well-managed do that. The other thing I want to say is about this wattage thing, 395 watts is not huge.

[01:55:31] Just for some context, typical refrigerator, I think it's about 600 watts. Typical vacuum cleaner is 900 watts. Typical hairdryer. Hairdryers start at 900 watts. This is a 395 watt solar panel.

[01:55:49] So we're talking about almost like 40% of a hairdryer here for plugging in. It's not something that's going to fry a building or burn an apartment down. It's something that will give our constituents a little bit of affordability. for small investment and allow them to have some freedom so we need to pass this bill senator you were the final speaker but now the senator from isle of white wishes to speak senator has the floor thank you madam president with the center from eastern fairfax yield for a question will you yield senator oh you senator has the floor thank you my president um senator i would ask

[01:56:29] what brand of hair dryer do you use obviously no brand yeah my my seatmate said my seatmate says I use a Tesla as a hairdryer. The senior senator from Virginia Beach wishes to speak. Madam President I'm not gonna keep droning on about this one but I'd like to ask a gentleman from I believe it's Western Fairfax one last question.

[01:56:56] Eastern Fairfax. Eastern Fairfax. Senator will you yield? I knew that. Senator has the floor. And Madam President I asked the gentleman in line 93 and throughout the bill it says has a maximum power output of not more than 1200 watts if he can explain how he keeps saying 395 watts but the bill says 1200 watts here for these units am i missing something what's the discrepancy here thank you senator from eastern fairfax no he's right so i'm sorry

[01:57:33] 1200 watts is the maximum output of the solar panel and then um but it has to uh it has to um on lines 100 it has to have maximum power output to the receptacle outlet of not more than 391 watts is exempt from the product listing to require alterations to the building's premises so that that's what that's

where the 391 comes from and i think it's mentioned also later on 391 i think comes up later in the bill as well seeing no further senators who wish to speak the question

[01:58:12] is shall house bill 395 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 30 nos 8 and rule 36 1. ayes 30 nos 8 rule 36 1

[01:58:44] house bill 395 passes pass bill 636 a bill A bill relating to prohibiting employers seeking wage or salary history of prospective employee wage or salary range, transparency, cause of action.

[01:59:10] Reported from the Committee on Commerce and Labor with an amendment. Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendment from the Committee on Commerce and Labor be agreed to? All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The amendment is agreed to.

[01:59:27] Senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, a move that the bill passed, I'd like to speak to that. Senator has the floor. Madam President, with the amendment, this bill is identical to Senate Bill 215, a bill from the senator from Northern Fairfax that passed this body on a healthy vote, I think 21 votes several weeks ago.

[01:59:46] The clerk, when she read the title of the bill, pretty much described what this bill is about. It's about preventing transparency or increasing transparency with respect to what people sound range is and and prohibiting that from get from them getting an interview or a job the amendment that we adopted was also adopted in the House on the Senate bill it creates a 15 day cure period for violation of the bill's posting requirements I reiterate my motion that it pass the question is shall House Bill

[02:00:22] 636 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes I those opposed no. Are the Senators ready to vote? Have all the Senators voted? Do any Senators desire to change their vote? The Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 20, noes 19. Ayes 20, noes 19. House Bill 636 passes. House Bill 893, a bill relating to electric utility integrated resource planning energy storage resources reported from

[02:00:58] committee on commerce or labor senator from charlottesville and i moved the bill passed i'd like to speak to that senator has the floor madam president it's interesting to look at the the bills that could flow through here some pick up a fever on the other side of the hall and some pick up a fever on this side this is a bill that got 98 votes on the other side but kind of a call a little fever and committee and came out on a partisan vote it simply requires dominion energy as part of its IRP to assess the use of energy storage resources through appropriate modeling that accounts for economic charge and discharge times and represents various economic scenarios.

[02:01:38] The bill also requires systematically evaluating and permits proposing investments in energy storage resources in the IRP. I hope that it passes. The question is, shall House Bill 893 pass?

[02:01:54] in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 20 noes 19 ayes 20 noes 19 house bill 893 passes house bill 1002 a bill relating to certain utilities notice procedures for non-payment report from the reported from the

[02:02:25] the Committee on Commerce and Labor. Senator from Charlottesville. The bill passed and speaking to that motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, this bill simply requires utilities when

they are disconnecting services or providing notices of disconnect to do it in the language of the people that are receiving the notice. I hope the bill will pass. The question is, shall House Bill 1002 pass? All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no.

[02:02:59] are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 21 nose 18 eyes 21 nose 18 house bill 1002 passes house bill 1173 a bill relating to virginia human rights act reasonable accommodation for known limitations related to menopause report reported from the committee on commerce and labor with the substitute senator from charlottesville madam president i move that the committee substitute be

[02:03:39] agreed to the question is shall the substitute from the committee on commerce and labor be agreed to all in favor of that motion will say aye those opposed no the eyes have it the substitute is agreed to senator from charlottesville madam president i move that the bill passed and speaking to that motion senator has the floor mad madame president with the substitute this language is identical to the Senate Bill 258 that came from the senator from Western Fairfax that passed this body several weeks ago with another healthy vote. It amends provisions of the Human Rights Act that provide employment protections, reasonable accommodation for known limitations related

[02:04:15] to pregnancy, childbirth, or related medical conditions to include menopause and parent menopause. I hope you'll vote for the bill. Thank you. The question is, shall House Bill 1173 pass? all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[02:04:44] the roll eyes 20 nose 19 eyes 20 nose 19 house bill 1173 passes post bill 1309 a bill to amend and read a bill relating to consumer finance companies additional charges reported from the the committee on commerce and labor senator from Charlottesville madam president move that the bill passed I'd like to speak to that senator has the floor madam president this bill simply provides that for the purposes of the prohibition on additional charges by consumer finance companies exceptions to

[02:05:23] the such prohibition include charges for guaranteed asset protection waivers for the protection and benefit of the borrower in connection with any loan and charges for guaranteed loan asset protection insurance for the protection and benefit of the borrower in connection with any loan I think this was an agency bill and I reiterate my motion that the bill passed the question is shall House Bill 1309 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators

[02:06:00] voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0. House bill 1309 passes. Uncontested calendar. Senate bills on third reading. Senate bill 3, Senate bill 835. A bill to amend the code of Virginia by adding in title 59.1, a chapter number 22.25 consisting of

[02:06:36] section number 59.1-284.46 relating to solid rocket motor manufacturing grant fund reported from the committee senator from portsmouth thank you madam president madam president i move that the bill passes speaking to that senator has the floor madam president this is an mei approved a project uh that was approved on february 13th 20 this year um both budgets include 2.3 million dollars

[02:07:11] the general fund the second year uh for the custom performance grant incentive program it creates a solid rock motor manufacturing grant fund to provide up to 97.74 million dollars in grants

between july 1 2025 and june 30 20 45 and with that madam president i renew my motion that the bill pass the question is shall senate bill 835 pass all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close

[02:07:49] the roll I was 39 no zero I 39 no zero Senate bill 835 passes Senate bill 836 a bill relating to transformer manufacturing expansion grant fund senator from Portsmouth thank you madam president again I move that the bill passed and again this is an MEI approved project and what it does it creates a transformer manufacturing expansion grant fund to provide up to 60 million dollars in grants between July 1 2025 and June 30 2040 to a qualified company

[02:08:27] that engages in the manufacturing of electrical transformers and is expected to create at least 1.185 new full-time jobs. The question is shall Senate Bill 836 pass. All in favor of that motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote?

[02:08:55] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no zero. Ayes 39, no zero. Senate Bill 836 passes. Uncontested calendar. House bills on second reading. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move all the House bills on second reading and the uncontested and regular calendars, pages 40 through 65 house bill 82 through 1492 that the rules be suspended in the second constitutional reading of the titles be dispensed with the question is shall the rules be suspended in the second reading of the titles of the house bills on the uncontested and regular calendars

[02:09:33] pages 40 through 65 house bill 18 through house bill 1492 be dispensed with all in favor of that motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The reading of the titles is dispensed with. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, President. I move that all those bills go by for the day. The question is,

[02:10:13] shall the house bills on the uncontested and regular calendars now on their third reading go by for the day? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The bills go by for the day. Uncontested calendar. Senate joint resolutions on first reading.

[02:10:36] Senate joint resolution 139. Confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly February the 2nd, 2026. Senate joint resolution 140. Confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly, February 23rd, 2026. Memorial Resolutions. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the Memorial Resolutions on pages 66 through 71, H.J.R. 124 to S.R. 97, be considered

[02:11:12] a block in the usual manner, waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof. With the understanding that a senator's resolution be removed from the block, we'll do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. The question is, shall the Memorial Resolutions on pages 66 through 71, HJR 124 through SR 97 be considered in the block in the usual manner, waiving the reading of the resolutions thereof with the understanding that any senator desiring a resolution be removed from the block will do so after the clerk has read the title of the

[02:11:45] resolution. All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are now before us in the block. The clerk will read the titles of the

memorial resolutions. House Joint Resolution 124. Celebrating the life of Edith Marie Kearney Hurd. House Joint Resolution 162. Celebrating the life of James Woodrow McLaughlin.

[02:12:14] House Joint Resolution 163. Celebrating the life of George Franklin Atwell. House Joint Resolution 165. Celebrating the life of Lieutenant Colonel Richard Thomas Boulevard, United States Army Reserve. House Joint Resolution 171. Celebrating the life of Cecilia Talaferra Tucker. House Joint Resolution 175. Celebrating the life of John Willie Parker Sr. House Joint Resolution

[02:12:53] 176, celebrating the life of Barbara Radcliffe Gray. House Joint Resolution 182, celebrating the life of Jane Camps Strauss. House Joint Resolution 184, celebrating the life of Alan Merrill Schumann. House Joint Resolution 185, celebrating the life of Jane Pasoli Edmondson.

[02:13:23] House Joint Resolution 186, celebrating the life of Gerard Robert Langmuir. Senate Joint Resolution 118, celebrating the life of Martin Gerald Farber.

[02:13:41] Senate Joint Resolution 132, celebrating the life of the Honorable Charles Douglas Poindexter. Madam President. Senator from Franklin County. Madam President, may SJ132 come out of the block, please. 132 is out of the block.

[02:14:00] Senate Joint Resolution 133, celebrating the life of Even Morgan Jewell. Senate Joint Resolution 136, celebrating the life of Carrie Taylor Carter.

[02:14:16] Senate Joint Resolution 137, celebrating the life of James L. Johnson. Senate Joint Resolution 142, celebrating the life of Robert Elston Green. Senate Joint Resolution 143, celebrating the life of John William Jones, Sr., DDS.

[02:14:41] Senate Joint Resolution 148, celebrating the life of Purcell G. Bailey. Senate Joint Resolution 149, celebrating the life of the Honorable Wyatt Beasley Durrett, Jr.

[02:14:57] Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. May SJR 149 come out of the block. SJR 149 is out of the block. Senate Joint Resolution 151: Celebrating the life of Charles Harry Carrico, Jr.

[02:15:14] Senate Joint Resolution 153: Celebrating the life of Franklin Delano Rianci, Sr. Senate Joint Resolution 156: Celebrating the life of Christian A. Jergensen III.

[02:15:33] Senate Joint Resolution 158: Celebrating the life of Ashley Elizabeth Harrell. Senate joint resolution 160 celebrating the life of Robert Blaine Maxwell the third Senate joint resolution 161 Celebrating the life of Malcolm Pollard McConnell the third Senate joint resolution 162 Celebrating the life of Elton Smith, Jr. Senate joint resolution

[02:16:09] 167 celebrating the life of Charles Frederick Downs Senate joint resolution 172 Celebrating the life of Joanne Terenzio Blakemore. Senate Joint Resolution 175.

[02:16:28] Celebrating the life of K-9 Alley. Senate Resolution 72. Celebrating the life of John P. McSweeney Jr. Senate Resolution 79. Celebrating the life of Walter Luther Young Jr.

[02:16:45] Senate Resolution 80. celebrating the life of Lieutenant Colonel Richard Grover Vaught, United States Air Force, retired. Senate Resolution 81, celebrating the life of Gardner Elliott Cobb, Jr.

[02:17:03] Senate Resolution 86, celebrating the life of Ola Parker Willoughby. Senate Resolution 87, resolution honoring Major Kevin L. Hughart.

[02:17:24] Senate Resolution 91, celebrating the life of Kevin B. Lyles. Senate Resolution 94, celebrating the life of Michael Allen Humphreys. Senate Resolution 97, celebrating the life of the Honorable Gerald C. Jones.

[02:17:44] Madam President, can SR-97 come out of the block and buy for the day? Without objection, SR 97 is out of the block and by for the day.

[02:18:06] The resolutions will be agreed to in the usual manner, that is, all resolutions except for SJR 132 on page 68 and SJR 149 on page 69.

[02:18:23] All those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolutions, please rise. The resolutions are agreed to. Senate Joint Resolution 132, celebrating the life of the Honorable Charles Douglas Poindexter.

[02:18:49] The Senator from Franklin County. Thank you, Madam President. I now move that SJ 132 pass in speaking to the motion. Senator has the floor. Madam President, members of the body, there are many of you who served with Charlie Poindexter when he was in the House of Delegates.

[02:19:04] First elected in 2007, served 14 remarkable years there where he made a difference for Southside and Southwest Virginia. He has a remarkable family. He was a remarkable man. He made a difference in the world. And he did it with no ambition but to do what was right.

[02:19:23] And he was just as comfortable here in the halls of this body or the body across the hall as he was sitting on his tractor in 102 degree weather, farming, cutting hay, playing with his beagles, playing with one of his, and hanging out with one of his 10 grandchildren, And especially Walker, his grandchild, who he spent many hours with in a place on his property in Glade Hill, Virginia, at his home place called Charlie's Shop.

[02:19:50] And if you were invited into Charlie's Shop, then you knew that you'd been blessed with the ability to hear great stories and be given great advice. Great advice even when you didn't ask for it. But it was great nonetheless. Charlie was one of a kind.

[02:20:05] He did so much for Southside and Southwest Virginia in those years that he served here, serving on the Appropriations Committee. in the House and also spearheading the widening of the longest highway that goes from Southwest Virginia from the coal fields to our shore in Route 58, which is going on right now because of his efforts. And it will bring and has brought great economic opportunities to Southside and Southwest Virginia. If you'll allow me, Madam President, I'd like to read just a quote from him when he gave his farewell speech in the House of Delegates. He said, quote,

[02:20:42] Leaving public service would be easy if you've tried to do the right thing while you've been here, if you've been true to yourself, and if you feel you've made an impact. Charlie met all three of those conditions, and the same could be said of him leaving this earthly world for heaven.

[02:21:00] First, most certainly, Madam President, he walks with the angels now. Well done, my good and faithful servant, as Matthew 25, 23 says. he will be missed. He will not be forgotten. And in the hearts of many in Southside and Southwest Virginia, he will be remembered and will never be forgotten. And so based on that, Madam President, I renew my motion that SJ-132 pass. The Senator from Roanoke. Thank you, Madam President. Just to speak very briefly. Senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. When Senator Smith

[02:21:39] was the target of the redistricting bill, as some of you all may recall, he ended up with a district that went all over creation and the second largest jurisdiction it was Franklin County and as soon as it was clear what was happening Delegate Poindexter took us all over the county and wanted to make sure that we knew everyone and everyone's grandmother and everyone's grandfather and he did everything he could to help us and what he did as a member representing Franklin and he really did represent basically all of Southside and Southwest Virginia because of his perch

[02:22:17] on appropriations, if there was something that we needed in one of our communities, he was going to go to bat for us. And my biggest complaint I ever had about Delegate Poindexter was if it was time to go get the hay, you would not talk to him because he was not reachable for a long time.

[02:22:36] He loved his farm. He was a great representation of the community, and I appreciate resolution. SJR 132, celebrating the life of Honorable Charles Douglas Poindexter, will be agreed to in the usual manner. All those in favor of agreeing to this memorial resolution, please rise. The resolution is agreed to. The Senate Joint

[02:23:16] Resolution 149, celebrating the life of the Honorable Wyatt Beasley Durrett Jr. Senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. Move the resolution pass in speaking to that? Senator has the floor. Madam President, it would be hard not to recognize the name of Wyatt Durrett in Virginia politics, certainly as I was growing up. I did not have the opportunity of knowing him in those days, but I got to meet him later on in life when he settled down in Middlesex County in Saluda, where ultimately he passed away. And as you all know,

[02:23:52] He was a member of the other body, but he had a long and storied career in Virginia politics. And because I know that there's a member of this body that had a long relationship with him, I would ask to be able to yield to the senator from Rockingham.

[02:24:07] The senator from Rockingham. Madam President, speaking of the resolution. Senator has the floor. Madam President, I and members of the Senate, I really can't remember a time when I did not know Wyatt Durrett.

[02:24:24] Wyatt was a fixture in Virginia politics back as early as the 1960s. Many of you know my personal history. I grew up in a political household. My dad and Wyatt were, you know, they were part of a gang.

[02:24:45] I mean, they conspired together to bring Virginia into a new political age. Wyatt was a great gentleman. Senator Stewart said that he settled down in Middlesex later in life. I'm not sure Wyatt ever settled down anywhere so far as I know, but Wyatt Durrett served three terms in the House of Delegates beginning in 1971, and Wyatt was destined for a greater role in Virginia politics,

[02:25:20] Even though he was never elected to another office, he had a tremendous impact on the direction of Virginia politics. He ran for statewide office three times. He ran against Marshall Coleman for Attorney General of Virginia back in, I think it was 1977, and lost in an epic convention fight in that race.

[02:25:49] And then turned around, wasn't daunted, and in 1981, he won the nomination to run for Attorney General and lost Jerry Belisles in that race.

[02:26:04] And in a number of great rematches over time, in 1985, he ran for governor again against Jerry Belisles. And in 1985 I had the opportunity to work in Wyatt's law office for mornings and I worked in his

campaign in the afternoons.

[02:26:30] And it was a who's who in that campaign. Some of you know Delegate Ware's aide, David Bovenizer. David was, in addition to being Delegate Ware's consigliari, he was Wyatt Durrett's consigliari as well, ran his policy shop, and Kirk Cox was Wyatt Durrett's driver during that campaign, and my wife, Suzanne, was the scheduler.

[02:27:04] And I remember many conversations in which back in the days before GPS, Suzanne was talking to Kirk on the phone saying, "No, you missed that stop sign. You had to turn left at the stop sign by the store and then right at the big oak tree in order to get to the dirt road that takes you to the event."

[02:27:25] It was, you know, a different day and time. And there are, I think, a bunch of us who at one time or another served as drivers for somebody in Virginia politics. But Wyatt was somebody who had friends all over Virginia and all over the political spectrum.

[02:27:45] He and Jerry Blouse became very close friends after those races. I grew to disagree with Wyatt about a lot of races. And I know that in 1985, he made news endorsing Tim Kaine, when Tim Kaine ran for governor of the Commonwealth of Virginia, and as a matter of fact, Tim Kaine, I believe, spoke at Wyatt's memorial service upon his death.

[02:28:12] Wyatt was one of the smartest guys I ever knew. He was a brilliant lawyer. of you may remember Don Lemons, former Chief Justice of the Virginia Supreme Court. Wyatt and Don Lemons were law partners. You may not remember that, but they were law partners here in Richmond, and it was a great partnership because those guys fed on each other. They loved the law. They loved, you know, continuing to reinvent themselves. When I first met Don

[02:28:52] Lemons, he was a divorce lawyer. And Wyatt was doing personal injury cases. Wyatt wound up at the end of his life practicing some of the most complex litigation that anybody in America practices, and I think he represented the relator in a giant whistleblower case in Texas near the end of his life, and never did give up the law practice so far as I know.

[02:29:24] I think I ran into him, the last time I saw him, was in the lobby of the SunTrust Bank as I was leaving to go to a meeting, and he was arriving, you know, 86 years old, dressed Justin is ready to go do battle in some conference room up in the SunTrust building.

[02:29:44] Wyatt was a true icon in Virginia politics and a good friend, a mentor in many ways to me, to my wife, and to many others who have enjoyed being involved in Virginia politics and frankly on both sides of the political aisle.

[02:30:06] He was a father, I think Wyatt had seven children, seven I believe, and loved his family dearly and will be missed. So I am honored to have been able to say a few words on behalf of this resolution celebrating the life of my friend Wyatt Durrett.

[02:30:32] H.J.R. 149, celebrating the life of the Honorable Wyatt Durrett, will be agreed to in the usual manner. All those in favor of agreeing to the memorial resolution, please rise. The resolution is agreed to. Commending resolutions. Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, I move the commending resolutions on pages 71 to 78, H.J.R. 135 to S.R. 96. Be considered a block by voice vote. Waiting and reading of any resolution with the understanding that any senator desiring

[02:31:10] remove resolution from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. The question is, shall the commending resolutions on pages 71 through 78, H.J.R. 135 through S.R. 96 be considered in the block by voice vote, waiving the reading of the resolutions with the understanding that any senator desiring to remove a resolution from the block will do so after the clerk has read the number of the resolution. All in favor of that motion, we'll say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The resolutions are now before us in the block. The clerk will read

[02:31:47] the numbers of the resolutions. House Joint Resolutions 135, 151, 156, 157, 158, 159, 161,

[02:32:01] 164 166 167 168 169 172 173 174 178 179 180 181 183 187 188 195 Senate joint resolutions 125 134 135 138

[02:32:34] 144 145 146 147 150 152 154 155 157 16 59 163 164 165 166 168 169 170 171 173 174

[02:33:07] Senate Resolution 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 82, 83, 84, 85, 88, 89, 90, 92, 93, 95, 96.

[02:33:36] Senator from Stafford. Thank you, Madam President. If we could pull Senate Joint Resolution 166 on page 75 out of the block and buy it for the day. S.J.R. 166 on page 75 is out of the block and by for the day.

[02:33:56] The question is, shall the resolutions be agreed to? That is, all resolutions except for S.J.R. 166 on page 75.

[02:34:13] All in favor of agreeing to those resolutions will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolutions are agreed to. Senior Senator from Prince William.

[02:34:33] Inquire the Clerk. Does that complete today's calendar? Yes, sir. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The Clerk will report any announcements on the desk.

[02:34:52] Today, Thursday, March 5th, Committee for Courts of Justice will meet immediately upon adjournment in Senate Room A, the General Assembly Building. The Committee on Transportation will not meet. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Resources will not meet.

[02:35:08] The Committee on Finance and Appropriations will not meet. You can go enjoy the beautiful day. Tomorrow, Friday, March 6th, the Committee on Rehabilitation and Social Services will meet at 8 a.m. in Senate Room A. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Capital Outlay and Transportation will meet at 8 a.m.

[02:35:33] Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB. The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Resources will meet immediately upon adjournment of the Subcommittee on Capital Outlay and Transportation in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB.

[02:35:51] The Committee on Finance and Appropriations will meet immediately upon adjournment of the Subcommittee on Resources in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet 45 minutes before session in Senate Room 1.

[02:36:07] The Republican caucus will meet 30 minutes before session in Senate Room 1. Correction, the Democratic caucus will not meet tomorrow. The senator from Portsmouth.

[02:36:32] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 10.30 a.m. tomorrow. The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 10.30 a.m. tomorrow? All in favor of that motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[02:36:48] The Senate stands adjourned until 1030 a.m. tomorrow.

[02:47:11] Richmond, Virginia

[02:47:13] Senate Chamber

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[02:49:24] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia

[02:50:28] Chamber

[02:51:30] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia

[02:53:33] Senate Chamber

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[03:02:36] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[03:04:11] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[03:08:31] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

[03:10:32] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[03:15:09] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[03:16:53] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[03:21:38] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

[03:23:14] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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[03:29:35] The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

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[03:33:53] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[03:35:55] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[03:39:13] Be sure to stay connected with live sessions, catch up on past meetings,

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[03:40:11] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[03:42:16] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

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[03:46:55] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, chamber.

[03:48:37] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate chamber.

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[03:53:22] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia.

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[05:09:19] This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.



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